

# 12-13 Performance Review

## Manager Review

Jonathan Daniel Micklos

Performance Review: 04/01/2012 - 03/31/2013

**Reviewer:** Michael Nail

**Role:** Manager

**Status:** Completed

**Manager:** Michael Nail

### Overall Performance Summary

#### Employee Summary:

In this year, I transitioned from a Software Development Engineer to a Technical Program Manager. During this process the four main things I focused on were:

1. Writing tools to empower streamlined country/device expansion and helping to perform said expansions
2. Improving the detail page user experience
3. Mentoring SDEs on our team
4. Acting as scrum master for the team and clarifying project and scrum process for a predictable team velocity and burn down

My 2012-2013 goals and results were:

1. Complete security training: I completed this.
2. productize custom detail page creation: This was started this year. Systems built such as the build time configuration and the Kindle Category Configuration Service were built so that they could be reused by teams such as project-b.
3. Prime Buy Box Integration: This was not completed this year. Instead, it is intended that during the migration in this coming year to the Universal Detail Page architecture that we will be able to absorb the prime buy box.
4. create a new web service to facilitate automation of device sales: During this year I worked with the International Category Expansion team to automate the process of setting up stores and AWOBS for Kindle in new countries. While we were able to successfully run this automation for JP, CA and IN, in the end it proved that the amount of work required to perform this work was not worth it. Now instead, everyone on our team is much more familiar and comfortable performing core category expansion tasks on their own. Going forward as we transition to using the Universal Detail Page architecture in the coming year, store setup overhead such as configuring AWOBS will not be nearly as expensive.
5. automate Kindle Detail Page creation activities: The Kindle Category Configuration Service was started with this in mind. During this year it was successfully built to perform campaign copying for detail pages from a default template to new product detail pages globally.

#### Manager Summary:

Jonathan had a great 2012, beginning as an SDE, achieving a promotion to SDE II, and then transitioning to TPM. He learned, grew, and delivered a huge amount in that time. As an engineer he tackled the problem of automating launches and came up with a number of tools and approaches that helped the team scale, which culminated in the Ratchet Award at the end of the year. He also took on the role of scrum master and helped the team plan and estimate as well as execute. He has made a very successful transition into a TPM, working with teams both internal and external, building

project plans, communicating statuses, unblocking impediments, and overall being extremely effective.

"Jonathan is a rising star in the dev team. He is responsible, super helpful, and is a very good communicator. He has more tact in him than most people I know. Sometimes meetings between dev, QA, TPM, and PM can get heated, but Jonathan always seem to retain his coolness and able to hear everyone out."

"I worked with Jonathan on multiple projects when he was a developer and was always amazed at his ability to "Hustle". Constantly working faster, trying harder, and moving sooner than his peers."

"Jonathan is a model for Amazon's definition of Teamwork and willingness to roll up sleeves - Fosters cross-functional and cross business teamwork. Builds and promotes team morale. Works efficiently and effectively on teams to meet customers' needs. Contributes outside the scope of the job. Meets all team commitments. Consistent effort, intense commitment, and willingness to go above and beyond when needed. Willing to do low profile, non-challenging work to get the project done."

"He brings passion to all he does"

"He's also a member of the team who has built a lot of trust within the PM organization: whenever there's a hard problem or an issue, Jon figures it out. This can be attributed to his sense of ownership, his tireless pursuit of figuring things out, and his raw talent."

## Identify Strengths

### Employee Summary:

In this past year, in my opinion, the top three strengths I exhibited were Invent and Simplify, Think Big and Bias for Action.

- Bias for Action: There were a few situations over the last year when an opportunity arose which needed quick action, I made the call and acted. Examples include both implementation of solutions to unblock development on the team, implementation of code solutions for emergent business use cases and judgement calls on priorities. Examples of the implementation of solutions to unblock development on the team include:

- CSS File Aggregator: We were at the limit of the number of CSS files we could have on Kindle Device Detail Pages. In order to unblock our sprint, I wrote functionality into our CSS build mechanism which automatically combines these CSS files, yet still allows for overrides to work as expected. Without this, development on projects during that sprint would have been blocked as the new code would not have rendered in IE.

- Build Time Configuration: It had become apparent that the cost of adding and removing Kindle ASINs from the various mason configuration files was too costly. As a result, I decided to build a system which builds these configuration files from a simply in memory database of all recent generation kindles and their properties.

Examples of the implementation of code solutions for emergent business use cases include:

- Quickly researching and implementing a solution for EMWA in JP: Before the JP device store launch, it was decided that we would allow customers to sign up to be notified when more information would be available.

Examples of judgement calls on priorities include:

- Project and Sprint Process Documentation: In order to clarify how projects are made ready for and executed on by our team, I wrote documentation outlining our project and sprint processes. This work was done as apart of my transition from Software Development Engineer to Technical Program Manager this Year.

- Acting as scrum master: As scrum master, performing judgement calls on priorities and how to unblock developers was one of my chore responsibilities. We now have a predictable burn down and

velocity.

- Invent and Simplify: My main focus this year has been to make
- Think Big: Thinking big to help not just the problem at hand but, the greater picture is how I try to think when at all prudent/possible. Making the build time configuration extendible to various types of configuration as well as generalizing the JP EMWA code so that it could be reused in other countries such as BR.

### **Manager Summary:**

Jon has a number of strengths and embodies our leadership principles. It is hard to narrow down the list, but these are the ones that he has done exceptionally well in this year.

#### **Ownership**

"Jonathan cares about getting things done right and works tirelessly to make sure this happens. In this he shows a great deal of OWNERSHIP.

For example, during the Gen5 Device Launch project I was responsible for testing the OPL Redirect feature and was revamping the test automation. In discussions with Jonathan I describe what I envisioned in a test harness for the feature that would allow functionality to be tested without the labourious task opening a detail page and going through the checkout process. Jonathan understood immediately the usefulness of the tool and spent that weekend modify the current tool to fit my needs. Because I had access to this tool I was able to reduce a two week test effort to 3-4 days."

" From Gen 5 launch to detail page widgets to his work helping to diagnose and solve problems on the fly (as he did with device availability messaging), Jonathan can always be counted on. He consistently insists on the highest standards, and vocalizes concerns when he feels a fast workaround won't meet the bar for quality. "

"As a site merchandiser, one of the things I most appreciate is Jon's ability to explain campaign elements while providing background and context - by 'teaching us to fish,' he helps our team better understand and articulate current detail page and site capabilities in meetings with PMs and other business stakeholders. This dissemination of knowledge helps foster better understanding around project scope, and helps us ask the right technical questions when drawing up project requirements."

#### **Innovate and Simplify**

Time and again, Jon will see a problem and come up with a creative solution. Here are a couple of great ones, in the words of his colleagues:

"Jon contributed great work to this team and made this team successful in the past year. He created the Build Time Config, which made a significant change to the way we managed ASINs, weblabs and OPL. He created the Feature Group based on BrowserScripts, which saved us from the long time going headache about the stylesheet limitation."

"[situation] Kindle detail pages had more than 31 CSS blocks, which caused some CSS to not be rendered in production. Furthermore, developing for Internet Explorer was time-consuming, because when we needed to develop for IE, we had to manually disable CSS files that we did not need, so that CSS that we were working on would show up properly.

[behavior] Jon came up with the concept of functionality groups and implemented it. Not only are CSS files merged in production, they are also merged on developer desktops when overriding the package. This does not require any time or effort from developers.

[impact] We are no longer over the CSS limit in production and CSS is working properly.

Furthermore, our team does not have to spend time manually disabling CSS files when developing for Internet Explorer."

"Implemented Kindle Category Configuration Service for running device and category expansion automation for KiSIT. The types of automation are for tasks which would be required during either the addition of a new Kindle Device to a given locale's Kindle Device Store or the addition of a new Kindle Device Store locale. Some of the tasks which we currently perform by hand through content symphony were replaced by automation in the KCCS. Its immensely beneficial tool to quickly address the needs of setting up new Kindle Device Store in a locale or launching new devices in existing locale"

#### Hire and Develop the Best:

Jon thinks big and has a bias for action, but even more importantly he inspires and teaches those around him to embody these leadership principals as well.

"Jon has promoted cooperation and commitment within a team to achieve goals and deliverables. He has enabled co-workers to grow and succeed through feedback, instruction, and encouragement."

"I think he has done a good job at coordinating dev activities and also empowering other dev team members to step up. I really saw this during the HAM project. He did the right amount of intervention needed to get Swepna back in the right direction, but also gave her room to show her leadership skills."

"[situation] A couple of months after I joined the company, I was looking for an opportunity to grow and learn new things.

[behavior] Jon saw an opportunity in a co-branded feature doc for AARP, had me work on this project and provided coaching when appropriate.

[impact] Thanks to Jon's leadership, I was able to strengthen both my soft skills and my software development skills."

### Identify Areas for Improvement

#### Employee Summary:

- Hire and Develop The Best: While at Amazon, I don't believe there has been one person who I have recommended for a position who has been hired. In the coming year, I need to work harder at this. Additionally, now as a Technical Program Manager, I need to be able to let go of my role as an Software Development Engineer role. This means also continuing to mentor those on our team.

- Earn Trust of Others: This is an area I wish to work on in the coming year. In the coming year, as we work to further productize our custom detail pages, we will be working more and more with new teams. As this happens, I need to be able to quickly earn the trust of those we work with.

- Customer Obsession: Specifically, I want to work harder at working backwards. As a new Technical Project Manager, I want to work harder to focus on the problem from the customer first. This is by far the number one way to develop for the customer what the customer needs and wants.

#### Manager Summary:

##### Earn Trust of Others

Jon is good at a lot of things, including being vocally self-critical - I don't think he is lacking in customer obsession or hiring and developing the best. His one main area of improvement is in earning trust of others. Jon has a habit of trying to do too much too fast, and needs to remember to slow down, choose his words carefully, and always underpromise and overdeliver.

"Jonathan would do well to listen to Dagnet's Sgt. Joe Friday character and when answering a question provide "Just the facts, ma'am". He should realize that others trust his judgment and if they

want they will ask for more details on how he came to his answer. Always giving a justification for his responses paradoxically erodes others trust in him."

"I am not saying Jon was lacking of stay focus. But I often heard he complained there was not enough time for him to accomplish his own administrative tasks and got randomized by other issues. As we all know Amazon Kindle is a very fast pace organization, I suggest he might want to prioritize a list of things that he needs to accomplish and make sure follow the schedule. Otherwise, it is not sustainable."

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| <b>Ratings</b> |
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**Performance Rating:** Achieves

**Leadership Principles Rating:** Solid Strength